

OHIO RIVER TRAIL COUNCIL
NORTHSHORE TRAIL
MIDLAND BOROUGH
936 MIDLAND AVENUE
MIDLAND, PA 15059

TO: North Shore Communities

FROM: Diane M. Kemp, Chairman

DATE: January 12, 2011

SUBJECT: DCNR Grant Award for the Ohio River North Shore Trail Feasibility Study

Midland Borough has received a grant in the amount of \$29,000.00 from the Pennsylvania Department of Conservation and Natural Resources to assist in hiring a professional consultant to provide services that are required for the writing and development of the Ohio River North Shore Trail Feasibility Study.

As part of that initiative, it is requested that you attend a meeting scheduled for 10:00 A.M., on Friday, February 4, 2011, at the Vanport Township Municipal Building located at 477 State Avenue, Vanport, PA 15009.

The meeting will be an open forum for all participating municipalities in the North Shore Study. The intent of the meeting is to develop a scope of work that incorporates municipal needs and requests. It is anticipated that the meeting will last approximately two hours.

It is requested that you bring with you any materials that you feel should be included in the feasibility study. These items will not be returned, unless specified, but if the items need to be returned, it is asked that a time be coordinated to copy and return the materials to the owner. These items could include the following:

- Comprehensive Plans
- Bike/Pedestrian Plans
- Transportation Plans
- Long Range Plans
- Zoning Ordinances
- Subdivision and Land Development Ordinances
- Park and Recreation Plans or Studies (including park master site plans)
- Riverfront Development Plans or Studies
- General Community Maps

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- Any other plan that will assist in capturing your community.

It is, also, asked that you come prepared to participate in the meeting. Very pointed questions will be asked and it is requested that the attendees respond with honest feedback.

Often times, answering the difficult questions initially leads to more project participation and acceptance of the project by your constituents. For example if you are aware of property owners that are admittedly opposed to greenways, trails, parks and recreation, then those areas should be flagged and those concerns should be addressed.

It is critical that the appropriate staff member/members or elected official/officials attend this meeting in order for your questions, concerns and needs be expressed.

At the meeting, each municipality will be asked who the official contact for each community will be for future committee meetings, but, also, all are welcome to attend and become acquainted with the project.

If your municipality hasn't submitted your matching funds to support the feasibility study, it is requested that those funds be paid before or at the meeting. If your municipality has offered in-kind services for the project, a form will be given to those municipalities to keep track of your services. This form should be submitted quarterly to Midland Borough.

Your participation and group consensus will determine the scope of work elements. The following are examples of typical work elements and proposal items that you should consider before the meeting.

- Budget
- Timeline
- Number of Public Meetings and Location
- Number of Steering Committee Meetings and Location
- Number of Key Person Interviews
 - Who some of those key person interviews should be?
 - ❖ Private property owners
 - ❖ Road crews
 - ❖ Business owners
 - ❖ Schools
 - ❖ Others

- Survey or no Survey
 - If a survey, to whom would you send it and what outcomes are you looking for?
- Operation and Maintenance
 - Annual Costs
 - Annual Schedule
 - Options
 - ❖ Intergovernmental
 - ❖ Landscaper
 - ❖ Municipality Fee
 - Contract Out
 - ❖ Do you have a budget and if so what could you pledge to the project?
 - In-house
 - ❖ Do you have the capabilities?
- Goals and Objectives
 - Trail Route
 - ❖ Share Road
 - ❖ Separate Designated Right-of-Ways
 - Trail Use
 - ❖ Multi-Use
 - ❖ Single Use
 - ❖ Water
 - ❖ Storm Water Issues
 - Are there any?
 - Trail Surface
 - ❖ Paved
 - ❖ Gravel
 - ❖ Green Alley
 - Trail Option Amenities
 - ❖ Overlooks
 - ❖ Pavilions
 - ❖ Parking Areas
 - ❖ Trailheads
 - ❖ Signage
 - Timeline
 - ❖ Short/Long
 - ❖ High/Low
 - Budget
 - ❖ Per Segment
 - ❖ Per Municipality
 - Acquisition

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- ❖ Identify the manner to acquire.
 - If not feasible, the proper solutions to continue with the project.
- Donations
- Funding Opportunities
- Others

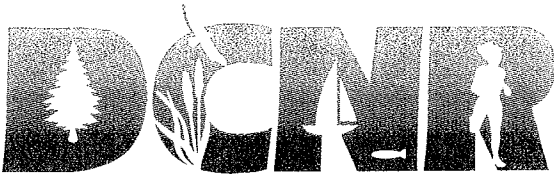
These are just some items to assist you in understanding what will be covered on February 4, 2011, 10:00 P.M., at the Vanport Township Building.

If for some reason your municipality cannot attend this meeting, please contact me at 724-643-4170, Extension 15 or by e-mail at mgr@midlandboro.org.

Thank you for your time and attention.

Enclosure

DMK



Pennsylvania Department of Conservation and Natural Resources

Rachel Carson State Office Building, P.O. Box 8767, Harrisburg, PA 17105-8767
Office of the Secretary

October 14, 2010

Mrs. Diane M. Kemp
Manager
Midland Borough
936 Midland Ave.
Midland, PA 15059

Re: Midland Borough (Beaver County)
Ohio River Trail - North Shore Trail Feasibility Study
Planning, Education and Technical Assistance

Dear Mrs. Kemp:

On behalf of Governor Edward G. Rendell, I am writing to congratulate you on a grant award in the amount of \$29,000 from the Community Conservation Partnerships Program administered by the Department of Conservation and Natural Resources (DCNR). Funding for these types of projects comes from the Keystone Recreation, Park and Conservation Fund (Key 93), the Environmental Stewardship Fund (Growing Greener 1), the Growing Greener Bond Fund (Growing Greener 2), and several federal funding sources.

One of this Administration's highest priorities is building community conservation partnerships with local governments, businesses, and nonprofit organizations to protect critical natural areas and open space; develop greenways and trails; provide quality park, recreation and conservation opportunities; and to improve the quality of life in Pennsylvania's communities.

Your DCNR grant award is a recognition of outstanding recreation and conservation work that should be shared with your community. To assist you, we have enclosed a Grantee Communications Kit. Our staff will be in contact with your project coordinator to finalize the grant agreement and to provide additional information on our grant procedures.

I wish you much success in implementing this project, which will contribute to the quality of life for many Commonwealth citizens. If you have any questions, please contact our Bureau of Recreation and Conservation at 717-787-7672, or e-mail us at DCNR-Grants@state.pa.us for assistance.

Sincerely,


John Quigley
Secretary

Enclosure